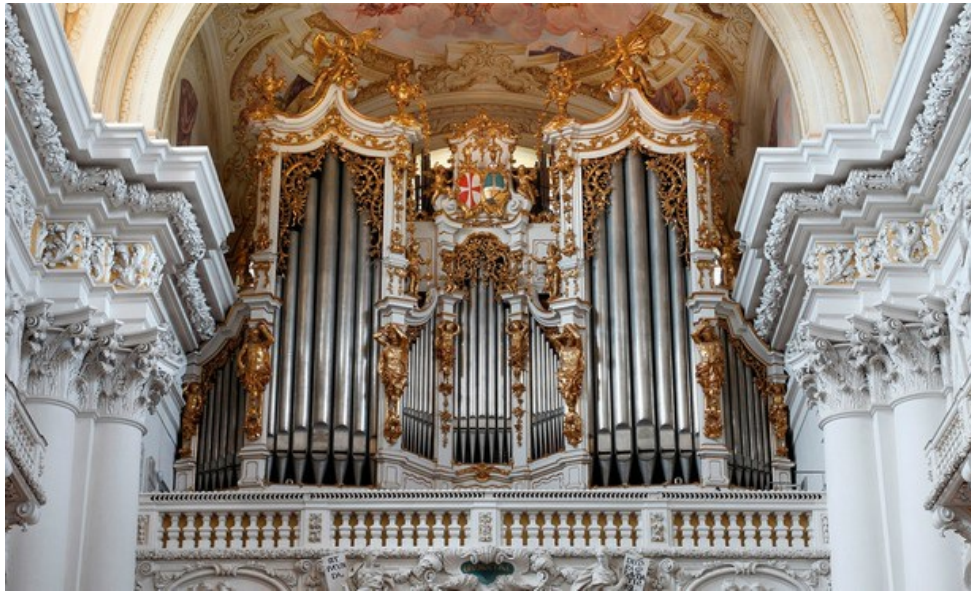


chores included spreading manure in the fields of his unlikeable superior's farm holding. The prior of St. Florian found him a happier post in the village of Kronstorf (where Bruckner wrote some early choral works), then in 1845 at St. Florian itself as assistant teacher. Bruckner stayed there for the next ten years, rising to the position of principal organist, and developing his phenomenal skill as an improviser on the instrument.



ORGAN AT ST FLORIAN CHURCH

As a young man in his early twenties, Bruckner was the principal organist at the glorious Baroque church of St. Florian in Upper Austria. He played this magnificent organ, which has been known as the Bruckner Organ since the 1930s. The composer's body is interred in a tomb below it.

From Linz to Vienna

In 1855, the organist of Linz's Old Cathedral died. Diffident and self-effacing as ever, Bruckner had to be persuaded to turn up at an audition for the post, and was absorbed in prayer until the organ-tuner suggested he try for the job. Bruckner's mighty